

2. Ethiopian Months (20 marks)

Problem designed by Monojit Choudhury

Here are the names of the Ethiopian months in the *Fidel* script along with their beginning dates:

መስከረም	ጥቅምት	ሕዳር	ታሕሣሥ	ጥር	የካቲት	መጋቢት
11 or 12 Sep	11 or 12 Oct	10 or 11 Nov	10 or 11 Dec	9 or 10 Jan	8 or 9 Feb	10 Mar
ሚያዝያ	ግንቦት	ሰኔ	ሐምሌ	ነሐሴ	ጳጉሜ	
9 Apr	9 May	8 Jun	8 Jul	7 Aug	6 Sep	

The transcriptions of the month names, in no particular order, are:

*Ṗagume, Gənbət, Taḥśaś, Ḥamle, Ḥədar, Mägabit, Ṭəqəmt,
Yäkatit, Mäskäräm, Nähase, Säne, Ṭərr, Miyazya*

Assignment 1 [[Answer Booklet](#)]: Match the names of months written in the Fidel script with their transcriptions.

Assignment 2 [[Answer Booklet](#)]: Sunday, አሐድ and Monday, ሳኞ are called *əhud* and *sañño* respectively, in Amharic. Transcribe the names of the other days using the same transcription scheme

ማክሰኞ (Tuesday), ረቡ (Wednesday), አርብ (Friday), ሐሙስ (Thursday), ቅዳሜ (Saturday)

Assignment 3 [[Answer Booklet](#)]: Write down in Fidel script the Amharic word for “Ethiopia”, which is transcribed as *ityopṗya* and contains the letter የ .

Notes: (1) Amharic is a Semitic language spoken in Ethiopia. It is the native tongue of more than 25 million people and is the second most spoken Semitic language after Arabic. (2) The consonants are pronounced like in English; a dot below the consonant (*H* and *T*) means that it is an *ejective* (pronounced with a kind of stress); *q* is the ejective form of *k*; *ś* is pronounced like *ch* in *church*; *ä* and *ə* are vowels.
